



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Professional Development

BUSINESS FINANCE SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the need for ongoing education as a worker.
2. Identify sources of career information.
3. Identify skills needed to enhance career progression.
4. Describe techniques for obtaining work experience.
5. Explain professional designations in the field of business finance.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of a senior financial analyst intern at SMITH & CO. FINANCIAL SERVICES, a financial advisory firm. The Vice President of the firm (judge) has asked you to meet with them to discuss your ideas on how students and early-career professionals can best prepare for a successful career in business finance. The VP (judge) wants your recommendations for a professional development plan that students can follow after high school.

SMITH & CO. FINANCIAL SERVICES offers a range of tailored services for high school students designed to foster financial literacy and promote early professional development. The firm provides foundational knowledge on topics such as budgeting, investing, and understanding credit. Additionally, the firm emphasizes the importance of soft skills like networking and personal branding. These programs not only introduce students to essential financial concepts but also guide them in building a professional network and exploring career paths within the finance industry. By engaging with these resources, high school students can gain early exposure to the tools and knowledge necessary for success in business finance, laying the groundwork for future educational and career opportunities

You will address the following topics in your presentation:

- The Importance of Financial Literacy
- Career Pathways in Business Finance
- Building a Professional Network
- Certifications and Education

The Vice President (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your information and answered their questions, the Vice President (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your time.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How would you recommend high school students and early-career professionals start building their professional network if they lack experience?
2. Can you explain how earning certifications like CPA or CFA can differentiate a candidate from their peers in the finance industry?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the need for ongoing education as a worker?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Identify sources of career information?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Identify skills needed to enhance career progression?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Describe techniques for obtaining work experience?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Explain professional designations in the field of business finance?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						